



**The Selectboard**  
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON  
TOWN HALL  
1 SOUTH ROAD  
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

**MINUTES of the MEETING**  
**Monday, May 20, 2024, at 7:00 PM**

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, May 20, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

**Call to Order**

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM

*Present: Maureen Dempsey, Chair; Susan Bronstein, Scott Johndrow*

*Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.*

**Request for Conservation Restriction Endorsement**

Bridgit Lively from Kestral Land Trust was present to request approval of a Conservation restriction on a 122 acre parcel currently owned by Norton Garfinkle; the land is proposed to be purchased by Kestrel Land trust, with the CR to be held by Mass Audubon.

It was confirmed that the property would be open to the public for all 'passive recreation', including hunting.

After further review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the conservation restriction, and to sign.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:03 PM)**

**Review / Approve Draft Letter of Support**

Mr. Finn presented a draft letter of support for a grant application to be submitted by It Takes A Village.

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

*To approve and sign.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (7:05 PM)**

**Department Reports**

**Highway**

Mr. Jablonski noted recent work:

- Removal of snow equipment from highway vehicles, including maintenance and summer storage.
- Some crew members are taking vacation time.
- Spring rains have required some culvert maintenance.

- Some cemetery maintenance and support.
- Some cleanup of intersection corners, and 'plow digs' leftover from the winter
- Maintenance and support for the cemetery tractor
- Easthampton road has been shimmed, prep for chip-sealing.
- All winter tires were off the trucks.
- Pothole patching and some crack-sealing of some winter roads.
- Street Sweeping: all parking lots and roads have been swept.
- Some old rotting wood was transported to Westfield.
- Southampton Road paving is completed.

...and other additional work.

Mr. Jablonski noted that he had received several requests for information or to participate in the Implementation Plan. He requested that any requests be forwarded to the Selectboard first.

There was some discussion about the ongoing work to try to find funding to complete necessary work on roads or bridges.

#### Police department:

Chief White was present. Mr. Johndrow noted that there had been late-night noisy activity at the elementary school in the evening. There was brief discussion about what could be done.

#### Board of Health

Ms. Katch Bachelor noted that Ms. Robby Armenti would like to be reappointed for another term; also, a new Covid variant has been identified, but it is proving to be 'like the flu', with mostly manageable symptoms, although it is still noted as quite virulent.

Ms. Bachelor noted that Ms. Janet Scully, Admin Assistant for the Foothills Health District, had left the Foothills Health District, and it remains unfilled.

There was some discussion relative to other types of potential infections, measures designed to prevent propagation, etc.

#### **Review / Approve Digital Equity Funding Agreement**

The board reviewed an agreement with Mass Tech Collaborative, reserving potential grant funds for Westhampton for implementation of the Digital Equity Plan, currently being developed by VHB.

After brief discussion, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve and sign the agreement.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:44 PM)**

#### **Review / Sign Election Warrant**

The board reviewed the election warrant, proposed to be held on June 1, 2024, from 8 AM to 12 Noon.

Mr. Johndrow brought up the hours of the election, and whether the board might consider extending the hours for polling.

The Board agreed that longer hours for polling would likely be appropriate, but directed that outreach be conducted to 'get the word out' about the election, including the in-person

early voting hours.

After further discussion, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the warrant, and to sign.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (7:56 PM)**

### **ARPA Appropriations**

The board considered two requests for ARPA fund appropriations.

An estimate for door awnings for the Public Safety Complex, from Chilsons Shops, at a cost of \$9,880.00, was considered.

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

*To appropriate \$9,880.00 for the purpose of new awnings at the Public Safety Complex.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (8:07 PM)**

A proposal to fund a solar PV array on the Town Hall roof was reviewed; no action taken; the matter will be added to the next agenda.

### **Administrative Business**

#### **Preview of Memorial Day Observances**

The program was reviewed, and some plans reviewed. Ms. Dempsey agreed to touch base with Bob Miller regarding sound amplification.

#### **Third Reading – ADA Grievance Procedure (no action requested until next regular meeting)**

No action taken. The matter will be added to the agenda for the next meeting.

#### **Review Correspondence**

A letter from Colonial Power was reviewed. No action taken.

#### **Review and Sign: Payroll and A/P Warrants: W24-24, WP24-24**

The warrants were reviewed. After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the warrants as presented.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:13 PM)**

#### **Review and Sign: Minutes from Previous Meetings**

Minutes from May 6 were reviewed. After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To approve the minutes as presented.*

**VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:17 PM)**

Upcoming Events:

Election: June 1, 2024, 8 AM to 12 Noon

Next Meetings: June 3, 7 PM; June 17, 7 PM

**Adjournment**

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

*To adjourn.*

**VOTED: 2, 0, 0 (8:20 PM)**

Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

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**Approved** by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on June 3, 2024.

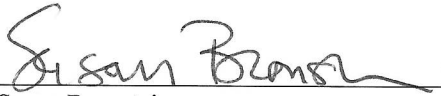
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Maureen Dempsey



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Scott Johndrow



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Susan Bronstein